

IESA PROCESS DAY 2026 • PITCH YOUR PROCESS

Building What AI Cannot Replace

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University of Ibadan • 10 September 2026

GOOD MORNING

You are the future.

- Of this country
- And I dare say — of the world
- UI graduates are built for global challenges

But in this department, it is even more critical.

The engine room of the nation

If Nigeria will be great, it will be because of how we industrialise:

What we know

**Our
capabilities**

Our traditions

Our culture

To industrialise is to break things into processes — and make every step a value element in the chain.

THE DIFFERENCE

**The local
akara seller**

vs

**The large
biscuit factory**

Not the recipe. The industrialisation of the process.

You are not just engineers.

- You can move Nigeria from consumer to producer
- Your concern goes beyond mechanical, electrical, civil
- It reaches into economics, social studies, psychology
- It touches every part of this country

“We are going to solve that problem.”

Why is insecurity still a problem?

Nigeria

- One Commissioner, on his own
- One General, on his own
- Nobody working together
- Security treated with kid gloves

America's defence sector

- Government
- Private sector
- Researchers
- All pointed at one agenda

LESSON TWO

We had the palm oil.

- Malaysia came to collect seedlings from us
- Today, they export it
- China is making garri
- We keep doing our own

Because we have not understood the power of industrialisation.

Every player stands tall.

The machine

The human

**The raw
material**

No player is insignificant. No player is treated with levity.

TODAY'S THEME

Building What AI Cannot Replace

Whoever came up with this theme must have been in the spirit.

WE DID NOT EVEN NOTICE

The question has moved.

BEFORE

**“Will AI take
our jobs?”**

NOW

**“Do we still
need humans?”**

- If my car drives itself, I will not hire a driver
- If my walls paint themselves, I will not hire a painter

Two questions

- 1 Can AI do everything humans need — or are we under-appreciating the human in the system?
- 2 If a process must last, deliver impact, and scale — are there values AI cannot produce?

The answer is YES.

The simple answer to everything:

OWNERSHIP

Everybody, say: ownership.

Ownership of research

Coca-Cola vs Pepsi

1

Research is beyond AI

AI collects the data



You decide what to collect

AI runs the analytics



You infer what is going on

AI writes the report



You created the agenda

The data that made Coca-Cola will never be in the public domain.

Ownership of creativity

The hallmark of every great revolution

2

Creativity takes four things



Wisdom: to see what others do not see.

“ChatGPT, give me an idea” → no ownership. You cannot take it anywhere.

Ownership of hard work

AI is an amplifier

3

AI will amplify who you are.

If you are lazy →

Laziness, amplified

If you work hard →

Hard work, amplified

Easier, faster, better — but only in the direction of your effort.

Two cautionary tales

The SIWES letter

- Copied straight from ChatGPT
- Black background still there
- [Name] and [Address] still there
- Will you employ that person?

The lawyer

- Used AI to prepare his arguments
- Six cited cases never existed
- Hallucinations
- He was fined

AI cannot replace you. It can support you.

- Walk in the park — talk your ideas to an AI, then ask it to summarise
- Preparing a pitch? Ask: “What have I not covered?”
- In a meeting? Let your AI assistant take the notes
- Need a second opinion, privately? Talk to the AI

Digitalise every step of your progress.

LET ME ASK YOU

Ten years from now, where will you be?

- Building something your company is proud of?
- Building something nations thank God for?
- Building something of national impact?

Let the answer be yes. But it takes YOU to do it.

MY CLOSING REMARK

Do not transfer to AI:

- Your studentship
- Your engineer-ship
- Your ambition

Be the creator. Take ownership. Follow the process.



Thank you. God bless you.

Questions

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